

Hollow Soul: Vision + Contribution Brief For Patrycja

A warm internal onboarding brief for story, RPG thinking, creative review, and project organization.

Hollow Soul - Alien Souls Roguelite - The Prototype - The Hollow Star - Derelict Sanctuary

Purpose: help Patrycja understand the current vision and see low-pressure ways to contribute without needing Unity or code.

Date: 2026-05-01

Audience: Patrycja, as a potential creative and organizational collaborator

Status: Friendly internal onboarding brief, not a contract or public pitch

1. Welcome

Patrycja, this document is meant to catch you up on where **Hollow Soul** is now and show a few concrete ways you could help if the project keeps pulling at your imagination.

The short version: this is no longer just a greybox Unity prototype with rooms and portals. It is becoming an **Alien Souls Roguelite** about a lost humanoid prototype, broken worlds, souls as dangerous fuel, and a derelict spaceship slowly reopening as the player survives more runs.

You do not need to know Unity, code, 3D tools, or game production vocabulary to be useful here. The project needs people who can think clearly, notice what feels meaningful, organize messy ideas, and help make the world feel like something players want to return to. That is exactly why this document exists.

2. The Core Vision

Hollow Soul is a modern 3D alien-souls roguelite.

The player is **The Prototype**: a lost alien humanoid execution-unit. It is not a classic hero, not a human knight, and not an evil monster. It was built to execute orders, but it has forgotten the orders. It wakes inside a reality collapse and begins searching for survival, fuel, purpose, memory, and home.

The collapse was caused by **The Hollow Star**, a cosmic anomaly somewhere between a black hole, a collapsed star, a high-tech disaster, and a wound in reality. It consumed worlds, myths, timelines, creatures, machines, and civilizations, then spat them back out mixed together.

The long-term home of the game is the **Derelict Sanctuary**, the Prototype's forgotten spaceship. At first, the ship is damaged and hidden behind reality anomalies. Over time, the player clears runs, consumes souls, restores systems, discovers rooms, unlocks portals, finds challenges, meets strange entities, and recovers pieces of what the Prototype used to be.

The emotional promise is:

Survive broken realities. Consume souls to keep going. Rebuild the ship that remembers what you forgot.

3. What The Game Should Feel Like

The tone is tragic, strange, adventurous, and sometimes unexpectedly funny.

We want the player to remember:

- A beautiful-but-dead cosmic world.
- A strange alien humanoid trying to understand itself.
- Portals into shattered dimensions.
- Souls that feel valuable, useful, and slightly uneasy.
- Fast combat where slashing, shooting, opening chests, and beating bosses feel satisfying.
- Weird encounters, like freeing an alien beast from a meteorite or meeting a drunk wanderer who only wants beer.
- The feeling of slowly reopening a mysterious spaceship and realizing it might belong to you.

Useful reference energy:

- **The Binding of Isaac** for random runs, items, rooms, and build surprises.
- **Dark Souls** for danger, recovery, bosses, and respect for combat.
- **Doom 3** for dark sci-fi mood and hostile spaces.
- **The Witcher**, **Baldur's Gate**, and **Expedition 33** for why small choices, characters, tone, and world texture can make a game feel alive.

The game should not feel like a generic space shooter or a simple dungeon crawler. It should feel like a cosmic RPG roguelite about identity, survival, and rebuilding something broken.

4. What Exists In The Prototype Now

The prototype already has a lot of rough systems in place. Many are still placeholder-looking, but the structure is growing.

Current systems include:

- Room-based runs with branches, doors, portals, hubs, and minimap.
- Melee and ranged weapons, stamina, guard, armor, and passive build stats.
- Coins, souls, chests, HP refills, shops, items, cards, weapons, armor, and set synergies.
- Boss framework with a planned roster of 10 bosses.
- Challenge mode with curated seeds.
- Developer Lab for inspecting entities and ArtPass prefabs.
- Room Designer for editing room layouts.
- ArtPass pipeline for replacing greybox visuals with real models and materials.

- World identity framing based on The Hollow Star and shattered dimensions.

Current direction:

- Ordinary rooms should give sparse rewards: coins, HP, chests, or nothing.
- Items should be rarer and more meaningful.
- Bosses should feel like major moments.
- The spaceship should become the real meta-progression home later.
- Combat feel and visual clarity matter more than adding endless new modifiers right now.

5. Why You Could Be Valuable

You could help because the project needs more than code and art.

It needs someone who can ask:

- Does this world make emotional sense?
- Would an RPG player care about this reward?
- Is this boss name memorable?
- Is this item exciting, suspicious, funny, or boring?
- Does this menu or milestone list actually help the team move?
- Are we adding too much before the basics feel good?
- What would make the spaceship feel like a place worth returning to?

Your strengths fit several useful lanes:

- You play RPGs and understand how story, world, character, and rewards affect motivation.
- You are good at thinking through ideas and noticing what feels off.
- You are likely good at small pieces of writing: descriptions, flavor, NPC concepts, quest fragments, names.
- You are good at organizing, which matters because this project already has many systems, milestones, docs, and moving parts.
- You can help translate "cool idea" into "clear next action."

This is the kind of work that quietly makes a game more real.

6. Open Contribution Menu

You do not need to choose one fixed role immediately. These are possible lanes. You can try one, mix several, or just start by reacting to the vision.

A. Narrative And Worldbuilding

Good if you want to help shape the world, characters, tone, and mystery.

Possible tasks:

- Write short memory fragments found on the spaceship.
- Create 1-2 line NPC dialogue ideas.
- Name bosses, worlds, rooms, items, challenges, and ship modules.
- Write item descriptions that feel mysterious, funny, tragic, or dangerous.
- Create small quest or event ideas.
- Develop the Derelict Sanctuary as a place with history.
- Help decide what The Prototype might slowly remember.

Examples of useful writing:

- "The machine calls this mercy. The soul disagrees."
- "A drinking saint trapped between timelines. He remembers every tavern except the one he is in."
- "This door was not locked. It was ashamed."

B. Creative RPG Review

Good if you want to play, watch, or read ideas and tell us whether they feel meaningful.

Possible tasks:

- Review whether rewards feel exciting enough.
- Check if shops feel useful but not mandatory.
- Say which bosses sound memorable and which sound generic.
- Flag when lore is too confusing, too obvious, or too flat.
- Compare how a feature might feel to an RPG player.
- Help judge if the game is becoming too complicated too early.

This is not "just feedback." It is design sense.

C. Organization And Producer Support

Good if you want to help turn chaos into progress.

Possible tasks:

- Maintain a simple decision log.
- Organize milestone notes into readable task lists.
- Track item, boss, room, NPC, and asset status.
- Keep a "what is done / what is blocked / what needs review" list.
- Prepare short meeting summaries.
- Help create checklists for Martin, Rafal, and future helpers.
- Keep docs from becoming scattered.

This is extremely valuable because the project already has many systems and a lot of momentum. Momentum is good, but it needs rails.

D. Content Design Support

Good if you like designing small gameplay ideas without needing to implement them.

Possible tasks:

- Design cursed items that are tempting but risky.
- Create challenge concepts with fixed rules.
- Suggest strange spaceship modules.
- Invent shopkeeper or NPC behaviors.
- Write secret room concepts.
- Create funny or tragic optional events.
- Suggest item synergies based on themes.

Example:

Cursed item: "Borrowed Halo"

Effect: Gives strong defense until the player takes a boss hit. Then it breaks and permanently lowers max HP for the run.

Tone: Beautiful, suspicious, probably a bad idea, exactly why someone will take it.

7. A Low-Pressure 2-week Starter Pack

If you want a simple way to begin, this would be enough:

1. Read the current GDD V1.
2. Write 5 NPC or event ideas.
3. Write 10 flavor descriptions for items, bosses, worlds, or ship rooms.
4. Make a simple content tracker idea or checklist.
5. Share RPG-feel feedback: what sounds exciting, confusing, generic, or worth expanding.

None of this needs to be final. Drafts are useful. Messy thoughts are useful. Even "this part does not make me care yet" is useful if it helps us improve the game.

8. First Areas Where Your Taste Would Help

These are especially good places for your perspective:

The Derelict Sanctuary

What rooms should the ship eventually have? Which rooms feel emotional? Which feel practical? Which should be unlocked early?

Possible modules:

- Memory Chamber.
- Portal Engine.
- Soul Furnace.
- Challenge Terminal.
- Workshop.
- Archive of Failed Orders.
- Containment Cell.
- Crew Quarters with no crew.
- Bar or mess hall where one impossible NPC appears.

NPCs And Recruited Entities

Who could live on the ship later? Not a full town yet, but strange presences.

Possible directions:

- A drunk survivor who remembers the wrong apocalypse.
- A creature freed from a meteorite who becomes a ship companion.

- A priest-machine that blesses weapons but hates violence.
- A merchant who sells comfort at a price that feels wrong.
- A failed prototype who knows too much.

Item And Boss Flavor

Items need names, effects, and personality. Bosses need identity before they need perfect mechanics.

Questions to ask:

- What does this item imply about the world?
- Why would the Prototype use it?
- Is it funny, sad, dangerous, or all three?
- Does this boss represent a broken world or just a large enemy?

Project Organization

The project needs simple, useful structure:

- Item catalogue.
- Boss catalogue.
- Story ideas list.
- NPC ideas list.
- Room and biome status.
- Art asset status.
- Decisions made and decisions still open.

This is the invisible work that helps everyone move faster.

9. What You Do Not Need To Worry About Yet

You do not need to:

- Learn Unity immediately.
- Write code.
- Make 3D models.
- Balance every number.
- Understand every milestone.

- Own a huge part of the game before trying small tasks.
- Be "correct" on the first draft.

The best starting contribution is simply helping the project think better.

10. How Collaboration Could Work

A practical rhythm could be:

- Once per week, review a small set of ideas or docs.
- Keep a shared list of story/content/admin notes.
- Pick one tiny output each week: 5 item descriptions, 3 NPC ideas, a checklist, a short critique, or a cleaned-up decision log.
- Treat everything as draft until it becomes useful enough to keep.

Good contribution format:

- Short is fine.
- Bullet points are fine.
- Weird is welcome.
- Clear criticism is helpful.
- "This is interesting but I do not know why yet" is also helpful.

11. A Few Prompts To Start With

If you want to start writing, try any of these:

- What did The Prototype's ship do before the collapse?
- What is the first room of the Derelict Sanctuary that should reopen?
- What kind of NPC would feel funny but still belong in a tragic cosmic world?
- What item would an RPG player immediately want, even if it is risky?
- What would a boss from a fallen future world be called?
- What kind of memory would make the Prototype seem less human but more sympathetic?
- What kind of shop purchase should feel useful but morally uncomfortable?

12. Final Note

Hollow Soul is still young, but it now has a clearer heart:

A lost alien prototype enters broken realities, consumes souls, and rebuilds the ship that remembers what it forgot.

If that world gives you ideas, then there is already a place for you here.